



YAQUINA BAY YACHT CLUB

750 SE Bay Blvd. Newport, OR 97365
541-265-9206 ybyc.email@gmail.com
www.yaquinabayyachtclub.org

Member's Handbook

Suggested Operating Procedures for the Yaquina Bay Yacht Club

Revised 2025

This document was prepared as the source for "how you do things" relating to the club. It's an ever changing manual that is updated when procedures or policies change, and is designed to hold details above and beyond the club's Bylaws. If you have questions about YBYC policies and operations please ask the Board for calcification.

Underlined items are from YBYC Bylaws

Non-underlined items are current YBYC Policy

YBYC Meetings:

Our monthly potlucks are generally held on the 3rd Saturday at 6 p.m. Please drop by and meet our members. Our Board of Directors generally meets on the 2nd Tuesday of each month at 6:30 p.m. at the YBYC clubhouse. Exceptions may occur to accommodate board needs.

Club Officers

1. The Commodore shall:

- a. Preside at all meetings of the membership and the Board of Directors.
- b. Appoint any member of the Club in good standing, with the consent of the Board of Directors, to any vacancy occurring in an appointive position in the Club for the remainder of the regular term of the position.
- c. Call special meetings of the membership or the Board of Directors, and shall prepare the agenda for all such meetings.
- d. Act as ex-officio member of all committees except the nominating committee.
- e. Assume other duties necessary to the best interest of the Club as directed by the Board of Directors.

2. The Vice Commodore shall:

- a. Preside at all meetings of the club and the Board of Directors when the Commodore is not in attendance.
- b. In the event of the absence, resignation or removal of the Commodore, the Vice Commodore shall exercise all the authority, privileges and powers of the Commodore.
- c. Assist with coordination/facilitation of the Operational committees.
- d. Learn club operations and event management, preparing for future leadership.

3. The Rear Commodore shall:

- a. In the event of absence, resignation or removal of the Vice Commodore, exercise all the authority, privileges and powers of the Vice Commodore.
- b. Focus on the coordination/facilitation and management of the Support Committees.

4. The Treasurer shall:

- a. Be the chief fiduciary officer of the Club responsible for the receipt and deposit of all Club money.

- b. Make all authorized disbursements to cover the expenses of the Club.
- c. Keep an accurate book record of all monetary related transactions.
- d. Make written reports of Club financial affairs as the Board of Directors may require.

5. The Secretary shall:

- a. Keep minutes of all meetings of the Club and Board of Directors.
- b. Handle the correspondence of the Club as directed by the Board.

Terms of Office:

Officers shall take office on the first day of the month following the November annual meeting and serve for one year or until their successors are elected and qualified.

Committees

1. House Committee chair duties:

- a. Preserving and maintaining all land properties of the Club.
- b. Scheduling and collecting fees for the facility rental.

Member Clubhouse Use Policy

Entry to the club is through the West door via keypad or key. You will be given the keypad code with your membership card. Please secure the building when you leave. Check all locked doors a second time.

Members are welcome to use the clubhouse unless it has been reserved for private use. Members under 18 years old must be accompanied by an adult YBYC member, when using the clubhouse. Please check the calendar in the clubhouse or the YBYC website for a schedule of events and respect the privacy of our renters.

Members may use the clubhouse for a small informal gathering of friends or family as long as it is understood that other members may be using the clubhouse at the same time. Members must remain with non-members at all times.

Members who want to schedule a private party must schedule it with the House Chair, pay the posted fee and security deposit. Gatherings such as business meetings, family reunions, large birthday parties, holiday parties, anniversary parties, weddings and/or wedding receptions will be subject to fees.

Each Individual and Household Membership may sponsor one use of the clubhouse by a non-profit organization, at no charge, each calendar year. The member will treat the non-profit group as their guests and take responsibility for such clubhouse use. The member must accompany guests at all times. Please care for the clubhouse as you would your own home. Ensure that the clubhouse is clean and all items are removed from the refrigerator. You can find the rental forms and rates on the club's website. www.yaquinabayyachtclub.org

3 Steps to Using the Clubhouse:

- 1. Before using the building: Check the calendar and contact the House Chair to schedule your event.
- 2. While using the building: No Smoking in the building. Do not make holes in the walls or wood, do not use tape on painted surfaces. Be careful with the club's furniture. Stay with non-members.

3. When you're done: Remove your items from the refrigerator. Clean up the building and grounds. Place bagged trash in the trash-can and place the trash can(s) outside for pick-up. Turn off appliances, fireplace, and lights, turn down the heat. Lock the garage door, windows, and doors.

Rental Fees

- All rental fees for use of the clubhouse for various types of non-member use are posted online and maintained in a file in the House folder of Board Folder on the Google drive that Board member have access to. These fees include rental prices as well as cleaning fees and security deposits.

2. Fleet Committee Chair shall:

Duties: Preserving and maintaining all boats and related marine property of the Club. Collecting fees for dock storage and/or moorage.

Duties of Fleet Committee also include:

- Timely preparation of boats for classes and events.
- Monitor condition boats after classes and events.
- Scheduling fleet related work parties as needed.
- Assist instructors and coaches with coordinating trailering of boats.
- Collect and file boat registration documents.
- Maintaining an inventory of club boats.
- Setting YBYC qualifications for members to use any YBYC vessel
- Maintaining a list of members qualified to use YBYC vessels in the Fleet folder on the Google drive that Board members have access to as well as copies of signed boat use agreements for those members.

Member use of YBYC vessels and dock space

Moorage on the dock: Individual, Household, Student and Military Members, non-members and Crew members is available for fees determined by the Board. The billing being July-June. Oversized boats may be charged for additional space, to be determined by the Fleet Chair. Current rates are maintained in the Fleet Chair folder on the Google drive that is available to all Board members and is available to any member from the Fleet Chair upon request. Fees may be paid monthly or annually to the Fleet committee Chair.

YBYC policy allows Individual, Household, Student and Military memberships to use select club boats at no charge when available. Members wishing to use YBYC vessels must be listed as qualified by the Fleet Committee and must have a signed boat use agreement on file with the Fleet Committee Chair before using YBYC vessels.

YBYC policy *recommends* Club members using any of the club sailboats, and *requires* members using club powerboats have their own Oregon Boater Education Card. Visit www.boatoregon.com for more information on obtaining your Oregon Boaters Education Card.

Anyone wishing to check a vessel out should contact the Fleet Committee Chair to reserve the boat. In the event the Fleet Committee Chair is not available, a back up contact will be posted on the YBYC website and the notice board in the shed. A calendar is posted on the club website showing which boats are reserved or otherwise unavailable. Provide and wear your own properly fitting, U.S. Coast Guard approved Personal Flotation Device (PFD) while aboard any club vessel.

- We will have clipboard in the shed with a sign in and sign out form for people who use the YBYC boats. Sign the boat out, sign the boat back in, and note anything that needs to be repaired on the clipboard.

The "you break it, you fix it rule" applies to use of YBYC boats. It is recognized that normal wear and tear will require YBYC to maintain these vessels. If something breaks on a vessel that is not due to normal wear and tear the Fleet Committee chair will inform the user of their responsibility to fix the boat in a timely manner. In the case of a dispute related to the "you break it, you fix it rule" the YBYC Board will form a committee to resolve the dispute. Decisions of such dispute resolution committees will be final and not subject to appeal.

Sailing fleet

- Sailboats available for use: The Club has a Capri 22 and Club 420 sailboats available for qualified members' use. Using the Capri 22 requires becoming a member of the Capri Club at YBYC. Details of the Capri Club are available from the Fleet Chair. The 420s are our training boats for sailing class and the high school sailing program, but they can be utilized while they are idle without charge. Some are stored on trailers at the clubhouse and others dry moored at the YBYC dock at Port Dock 7. A properly fitting wetsuit or dry suit must be worn when sailing these dinghies on waters of 60 degrees F or less. An adult-crewed chase boat must be present when club boats are sailed by members under 18. Qualified users may reserve dinghies for Wednesday night racing by signing up at

<https://spreadsheets0.google.com/spreadsheet/cc?hl=en&key=tZvTrAppsstef-nGGCMmWDA&hl=en#gid=12>

Power Fleet

Whaler:

- Not intended for personal use
- Operators must be checked out by the fleet chair or their designee.
- Should not be anchored when used for committee boat during races; must be available to render assistance.

Aluminum skiff

- May be used by club members for personal activities (crabbing, fishing, etc.)
- Must be returned with a full tank of fuel
- Must be cleaned when returned

3. Membership Committee – Chair:

Duties:

- a. Fielding membership inquiries via email and phone
- b. Reviewing applications for membership.
- c. Presenting applications to the Board for vote of acceptance or denial of membership applications or securing additional information about an applicant for the Board.
- d. Notifying applicants of the Board's decision via Welcome Email.
- e. Add new members to the Google email group and notify the newsletter editor
- e. Order and pick up nametags and Membership cards
- d. Maintaining an accurate database in coordination with the Treasurer of the current Club membership with associated appropriate information.
- e. Following up with members that have not renewed.

Membership Policy

Initiation and yearly fees must be paid prior to voting new member(s) into the club. New members joining mid-year will pay a prorated amount for annual fees. Contact membership chair for an exact figure. Those with lapsed memberships will be considered "new members" if wanting to re-join the Club - i.e., will need to pay Initiation Fees as a new member.

Members receive membership cards, name tags (stored at club), digital membership roster, digital information on use of clubhouse, digital YBYC operating procedures and digital copy of bylaws. They are also added to the YBYC google group and welcomed in the Jibsheet newsletter. Membership Chairperson ensures that new members are welcomed by the club and are provided with these items.

Fees

- Current fees including initiation fees are posted on the YBYC website and maintained in a file in the Membership folder on the Google drive that all Board members have access to. Membership fees are annual and determined by the Board. The classes of membership are defined below:
1. Individual: This membership is for a person 21 years or older who is single and is the only person living in his or her household. This individual may vote and hold office.
 2. Household: This membership is for a family unit with two or more people living in a household. All persons over 21 years of age in the household may vote and hold office.
 3. Student/Military: This membership is for any full time student or Active Military with current ID. Student members do not receive unaccompanied access to the clubhouse or hold elected office.
 4. Life Membership: This membership is for that small group of individuals who have set themselves apart by either being Charter Members (i.e., participated in the original creation of the club) or have met the criteria for life membership spelled out in the club's bylaws. Life Members may vote and hold office. Life Membership is granted for life, so any revision in qualifications does not affect the status of any current Life Members. Once approved by the Board there are no dues paid by Life Members.
 5. Honorary Membership: Persons inducted into the club for exceptional achievement or service in furthering the purposes of the Club. Honorary members may attend all meetings and participate in all activities of the Club without payment of dues but may not vote or hold elective office. Honorary membership is valid for the current calendar year in which it is bestowed.
 6. Crew Membership: An individual may join as a Crew Member for a maximum of 2 years and when sponsored by a Club skipper. Crew Members may attend all meetings and activities. Crew Members may not vote or hold elected office. Crewmembers may not use club boats or have access to the clubhouse.

Individual and Annual Membership Dues received prior to the November meeting will be discounted as an early payment bonus as determined by the board with members being notified by mail before the annual meeting in November..

4. Racing & Cruising Committee - Chair:

Duties: Directing and controlling of all Club sponsored races and cruises including planning of all races, responsibility for racing equipment, race 'committee', protest 'committee', trophies, race paraphernalia, interface with external yacht clubs, and interface to the US Coast Guard as required.

Wednesday Evening Race Instructions

Rules: Racing will be governed by the rules as defined in the United States Sailing Association's current Racing Rules of Sailing (RRS).

- Eligibility: Any skipper who has submitted a YBYC Wednesday Evening Racing Entry Form and Waiver (posted at www.yaquinabayyachtclub.org) to the YBYC Race Chair is eligible for racing. There is no entry fee for skippers who are YBYC Individual, Household, Student or Military members. Skippers who are not qualifying YBYC club members are required to pay an entry fee for each series. Current fees are available

from the Race Chair and maintained in file in the Race folder on the Google drive that is available to all Board members. All skippers should be members of US Sailing. The Portsmouth Yardstick rating system for time-on-time handicapping will be used. Non-qualifying members new to racing at YBYC may race on two Wednesdays before being subject to entry fees.

- Notices to Competitors: Notices to competitors will be posted on the official notice board located inside of the YBYC clubhouse.
- Schedule of Races: One race will be held each Wednesday evening per the schedule below.
- Spring Series consists of eight Wednesdays beginning with the Wednesday after the Spring Regatta. Warning signal on the water at 6:15 PM race start follows Starting Sequence described below. In the absence of a committee boat, the race starts at 6:21. Please note: a Fun Race that is not scored as part of the series will occur on the Wednesday after Memorial Day.
- Summer Series consists of eight Wednesdays beginning the week after the Spring Series finishes. Warning signal on the water at 6:15 PM race start follows Starting Sequence described below. In the absence of a committee boat, the race starts at 6:21. Please note: a Fun Race that is not scored as part of the series will occur on the Wednesday nearest to Independence Day.
- Fall Series consists of all the Wednesdays after the Summer Series finishes and before the Fall Regatta. Warning signal on the water at 6:15 PM race start follows Starting Sequence described below. In the absence of a committee boat, the race starts at 6:2 for races before the Labor Day weekend. After the Labor Day weekend all starting times are 15 minutes earlier due to day length. Please note: a Fun Race that is not scored as part of the series will occur on the first Wednesday of Sept.
- Classes: Keelboats and centerboard boats will be scored separately. Boats may be scored as one-design fleets if 4 or more one design boats are racing in the series. Classes may be combined for race starts.
- Courses: Courses will be displayed onboard the Committee Boat no later than 5 minutes before the start of each Race. Marks will consist of existing navigational aids (channel markers) found on NOAA Chart #18581 or marks set by the race committee. Marks are to be left to Port unless specified. The start/finish line is unrestricted. If there is not committee boat for a race, courses will be posted in the clubhouse before the race and upon request on VHF channel 68.
- Starting:
 - The starting line will be as follows:
 - One end of the starting line may be a mark set by the race committee or one of these three channel markers found on NOAA Chart #18581: CG, 12, or 12A. The other end of the starting line will be either:
 - A life jacket, red flag or YBYC burgee onboard the race committee boat, or
 - An anchored, temporary buoy near the race committee boat (if boat not anchored)
 - If there is no committee boat or buoy set then the start/finish line will be between CG and 12.
 - Races will be started per RRS 26. Times shall be taken from visual signals if there is a committee boat; the failure of a sound signal shall be disregarded.
 - 5 Minute Warning Class Flag Up; 1 sound
 - 4 Minute Preparatory P Flag Up; 1 sound
 - 1 Minute P Flag Down; 1 long sound
 - Start Class Flag Down; 1 sound

Optionally centerboard boat races may be started per RRS Appendix S: S3 The starting sequence shall consist of the following sound signals made at the indicated times:

Signal	Sound	Time before start
Warning	3 long	3 minutes
Preparatory	2 long	2 minutes
	1 long, 3 short	1 minute 30 seconds
	3 short	30 seconds
	2 short	20 seconds

	1 short	10 seconds
	1 short	5 seconds
	1 short	4 seconds
	1 short	3 seconds
	1 short	2 seconds
	1 short	1 second
Start	1 long	

- Class Flags:
 - “Spinnaker” Indicates Offshore Class boats sailing with spinnakers
 - “Sailboat” Indicates Offshore Class boat sailing without spinnakers
 - “PS” Indicates Centerboard Portsmouth Class boats such as 420s
- Finishing: The finish line will be the same as the starting line.
- Time Limit: The time limit for each race will be 1.75 hours for the first boat to finish. Boats finishing more than 45 minutes after the first boat that sails the course finishes will be scored DNF without a hearing. This changes RRS 35, 63.1, A4 and A5.
- Protests: Protest is discouraged; if infractions occur, please attempt to settle them on the water. Protests shall be sent to the YBYC Race Chair by mail with a postmark date no later than the day following the race in which the incident occurred. This changes RRS rule 61.3. The RRS protest form available at www.ussailing.org shall be used. Parties to a hearing will be notified of the date, location and time of their hearing.
- Scoring: The Portsmouth Yardstick time on time handicapping method will be used to calculate corrected times. Each series will be scored separately. Each skipper’s two worst scores will be excluded from her series score, if enough races are sailed. Each skipper’s season score will be the sum of their series scores. Keelboats without a current Portsmouth Yardstick rating available on the US Sailing website will be assigned ratings by the YBYC Race Chair based on the information posted on the Portsmouth Yardstick page of the US Sailing website. Non-YBYC members are not eligible to win season or perpetual trophies. Results will be posted on the YBYC website and updated at least every 2 weeks.
- Committee Boat: Each competing boat/crew should serve as the race committee boat for at least one race per series or as needed. A boat serving as committee will receive a number of points for the race in which they serve as committee equal to their average score for all races in the series including DNF and DNS.

Prior to the first race of the series, all skippers will have the opportunity to sign up for the night they wish to be committee boat. Committee boat duty may be assigned by the YBYC Race Chair if skippers do not sign up in a timely manner.

If there is no Committee Boat racers are responsible for using GPS times to determine start and finish times and recording their finish times themselves and providing it to the Race Chair so races can be scored.

Check YBYC website for updates to these Sailing Instructions at www.yaquinabayyachtclub.org

The committee bag is stored in the club’s office and should contain the following items:

Instructions on being committee boat

Clipboards with finish sheets

Dry Erase Board

Bag of Pens, Dry Erase Markers

Course Chart

Flags (3 fleet flags, 1 ‘P’ flag, 2 recall flags, 1 postpone flag, 1 abandonment flag)

Air Horns

A machine that will provide starting sound signals at specified intervals automatically
Stopwatch/Timer

Regattas

At least two regattas, open to all sailors, are planned to be held on Yaquina Bay each year. The Spring Regatta will be held on the last weekend of April. The Fall Regatta will be held on the weekend before Columbus Day. Notice of Race (NOR) and entry forms will be posted on the Yaquina Bay Yacht Club web site. Sailing instructions for regattas will be included in the NOR and at the skipper's meeting preceding the event.

A one-day Youth Regatta will be planned by the Youth Sailing Chair as appropriate for the competitive season each year.

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Racer of the Year Perpetual Trophy

The YBYC Racer of the Year perpetual trophy will be open to all club members sailing in YBYC events. Racer of the year is generally determined by looking at race scores for individual boats/skippers throughout the year with the lowest total score for an equal number of races for the season determining the winner. But upon occasion the Race Chair may have reason to award the Race of the Year trophy to another skipper when they determine that doing so is well justified.

Cruise Events

Cruise events will be listed on the YBYC Combined Calendar, but are anticipated to include Sailstice cruise on June 21, a trip up river to Toledo for their summer festival and fireworks, and a raft up.

5. Hospitality Committee – Chair:

Duties: Arranging for appropriate entertainment and/or refreshments for Club activities.

Monthly Meetings:

Our general monthly club potlucks are generally held on the 3rd Saturday at 6 p.m. Please drop by and meet our members.

Hosting a Yacht Club Meeting

- Hosting a yacht club meeting is simple, fun and helps promote boating on Yaquina Bay—and you do not have to do it solo! This is what you do:
- Send to YBYC newsletter editor a meeting announcement describing when the meeting is (date and time), where, what the theme is (i.e. chili cook off, dock party, October fest, etc.), and whether there will be any featured speakers, entertainment, etc. This announcement may be short and sweet or detailed and descriptive or anywhere in between.
- Purchase meeting supplies—these can include table decorations, prizes, food items, video rental, etc. Turn in your receipt(s) to the club treasurer after the meeting and the treasurer will write a YBYC check to reimburse you up to a limit set by the YBYC Board. Hospitality Chair will know the amount and maintain a record of it in the Hospitality folder on the Google drive.
- Arrive at the clubhouse in advance and make sure tables are set up and ready for people to come with food, drinks, etc. Decorate as much or as little as you like. Remember, people bring their own place settings, so no worries there!
- At the end of the meeting, see that the clubhouse is as clean as (or better than) when you first arrived.

6. Newsletter & Web Committee: - Chairs

Duties: Editing and distributing the Club Newsletter and Web page. Provide written notice of all Club meetings and activities to the membership.

The newsletter is published the weekend before the monthly meeting. For those of you wishing to contribute to the newsletter, please keep a couple things in mind:

1. Text contributions may be submitted in electronic format, and may be simply an email or may be an attached document in Word (or compatible) format, containing no special formatting, text boxes, etc.
2. The deadline for submissions is usually the second Thursday of every month
3. Submissions need to be emailed to the YBYC Editor see YBYC website for current Editor and email address.

YBYC has a website <http://www.yaquinabayyachtclub.org/> that provides information about the club, membership, events, clubhouse rental, classes, racing, newsletters and more. Check it out!

YBYC has a group formed on **Google** Groups. The web address is <https://groups.google.com/> This discussion forum is a way to post information of interest to members and also allows posting pictures. Crew, relatives, and friends are admitted on a case-by-case basis to protect the club's privacy and best interests.

The club's Bylaws and Member Handbook are posted on the YBYC website YBYC has also formed a page on Facebook to facilitate social networking and interaction.

7. Educational & Training Committee –Chair:

Duties: Responsible for coordinating all Club training activities and interfacing with instructors for those classes or activities. Classes may include: Adult Sailing Classes; Youth Sailing Classes; Kayak Classes; Club Powerboat training; Other training as required and designated by the Board.

- Coordination of these training activities is generally done with Fleet, Youth Sailing Chairs and certified instructors.
- The Education and Training Chair may also arrange classes on topics of interest to the membership throughout the year as deemed appropriate.

8. Publicity and Public Relations - Chair

Duties:

- a. Publicizing all Club activities and concerns to the general public, including races, regattas, training, cruises and others as directed by the Board.
- b. Interface with newspapers and radio media regarding Club activities.

9. Youth Sailing – Chair

Duties: Organize and oversee the youth sailing program at YBYC including the High School sailing teams. Interface with Lincoln County School District to ensure that the requirements for sailing as club sport at the High School level. Also work with Booster Club which supports the Newport High School sailing team financially. Coordinate with the Northwest Interscholastic Sailing Association (NWISA) to ensure our high school team qualifies to participate in NWISA regattas.

B. Support committees

1. Nominating Committee

The Nominating Committee will consist three members of which two members are selected by the Vice Commodore and one member selected by the Rear Commodore. The Nominating Committee shall be convened in the month of September of each year.

Duties: Selecting nominees for Club officers and operational committee chairpersons and submitting the names to the Commodore, after confirming that proposed nominees will serve if elected, in ample time for the Nominating Committee to notify the membership of the proposed slate of nominees via email 30 days in advance of the Annual Member Meeting date.

2. Historical Committee Chair

Duties: Maintaining a documentary and pictorial history of Club activities, elections, accomplishments of officers and members, and other items of interest for posterity.

3. Ship Stores Committee -

Duties: Promote sale of Club items, order merchandise, and maintain stock giving periodic financial reports to the Club Treasurer as requested by the board. Update and maintain sales information via Square

4. Planning Committee

Duties: Developing long range plans as directed by the board.

5. Special Project Committee - Chair: Rear Commodore

Duties: Perform special Club projects as directed by the Board